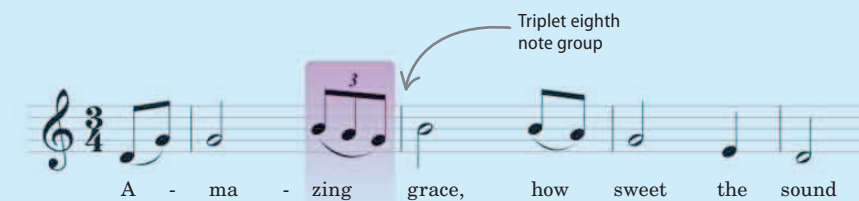


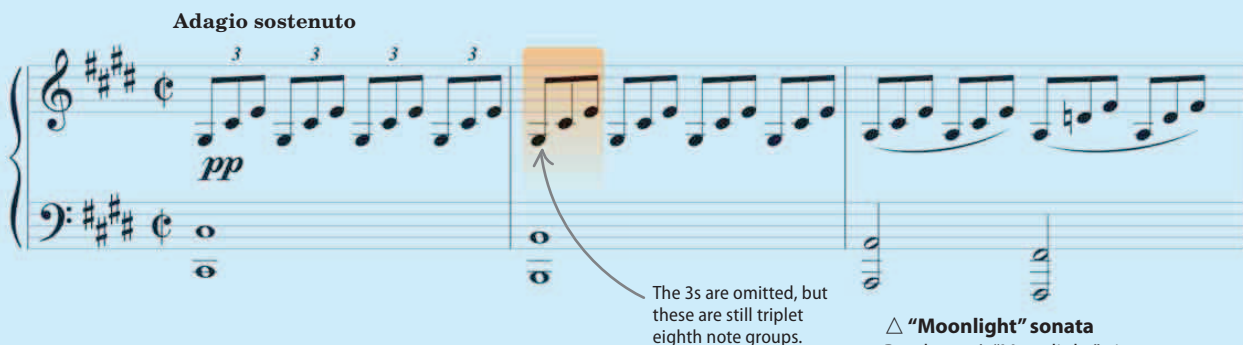
Triplet rhythms

One of the most familiar examples of triplet rhythms is in “Amazing Grace”, shown here. You can also hear triplets at the start of Beethoven’s “Moonlight” piano sonata. “These Foolish Things” also has, by Eric Maschwitz and Jack Strachey, triplets, especially in the chorus with the title words. Another good example is in “Turn, Turn, Turn” by Pete Seeger.



◁ “Amazing Grace”

Old songs are not always sung or notated in the same way. Some hymn books omit the note A in the triplet eighth note group, and just notate straight eighth notes for the notes B and G.



△ “Moonlight” sonata

Beethoven’s “Moonlight” piano sonata starts with a gently pulsing triplet. With the pattern established, the triplet 3s can be omitted after the first measure.

Duplets

Duplets are two notes in the time of three, which is an exception to the usual practice, whereby tuplet notes are faster than their regular equivalents. Duplets are much less common than triplets, but may occur in compound time.



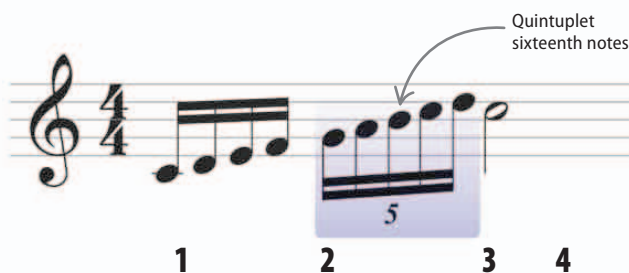
△ Duplets in compound time

This is a typical use of a duplet. Here two eighth notes are written in the time of three, within a 6/8 meter.

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Other groupings

Quintuplets are five notes played in the time of four. Other rhythms in which irregular numbers of notes are fitted within the beat are also possible—for instance seven in the time of four, or nine in the time of eight. All of these examples are given the general heading “tuplets.”



△ Quintuplets

Shown here is a group of quintuplet sixteenth notes. The five notes are played in the time of four.

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